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The Mongolian World

To the delight of Karl Jahn, the first editor of the present journal, academic interest in the history, cultures and languages of Central Asia has grown considerably. Founded by Karl Jahn in 1955, the Royal Asiatic Society (*Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society*, vol. 89, no.s 3–4 [October 1957], pp. 229–230) had the following to comment on the first volume of the *Central Asiatic Journal*: “Since the war, considerable attention has been focused on Central Asian Studies. The number of scholars working in this field has greatly increased and the need has been felt of creating a specialized periodical which ‘could serve as a forum for all those concerned with research in Central Asia.’ ... This beautifully produced [first] volume is dedicated to the great Mongolist, the Rev. Antoine Mostaert, C.I.C.M.”. Ever since, Mongolia has occupied a special place in the pages of the *Central Asiatic Journal*, becoming a veritable “forum” for researchers from the entire world. The first thematic annual volume fully devoted to the Mongols appeared in 2012 (CAJ, vol. 56), and the present 66th volume of the CAJ will have the same focus – as will the following volume 67. Such a wealth of articles would not have been possible without an academic groundswell of enthusiasm, providing a stable foundation for colloquia, conferences and collective projects. As opposed to 1955, today’s Mongolists and Central Asianists are mostly not separated by ideological barriers and hail from the entire world, in particular also from all three regions where the descendants of the Mongol khans live today: Inner Mongolia (People’s Republic of China), Outer Mongolia (Republic of Mongolia), as well as Buryatia (Russian Federation). Furthermore, international academic research focusing on the Mongols has been flourishing. “Voices from Mongol Eurasia”, an international conference being organised by Michal Biran, Nam Jong-kuk and Shin Dongkyung for June 2024 at Ewha Women’s University in Seoul, or the recent meeting “Mongols and Religion” held at Vienna (May 2019) as part of the Mongol Empire Spring Series, jointly organised by the Institute for Austrian Historical Research (University of Vienna) and the Institute of Iranian Studies (Austrian Academy of Sciences) are apt examples. The latter conference produced the majority of the contributions for the following volume of the *Central Asiatic Journal*, which is co-authored with the organiser of the latter conference, Prof. Francesca Fiaschetti. Volumes 66 and 67 thus represent the state of the art in international research on Mongolian language, history and culture – to the delight of Karl Jahn. This creation of both volumes would not have been possible without the impressive time-keeping and editorial skills of my colleague Dr Petra Himstedt-Vaid, to whom I wish to express my sincere gratitude.

The present volume begins with a linguistic analysis by Gao Jingyi 高晶一 concerning the etymology of mountain names in the linguistic borderlands of (later) Mongolia (“On the Etymology of Tian Shan, Kunlun and Sayan Mountains”). It is followed by a chronological exploration of the “linguistic DNA” connecting early

Mongolian and Turkic. Orçun Ünal, in his “On the Etymology of Common Turkic elt- ‘to carry, to bring’” provides empirical evidence for the interconnectivity between languages belonging to different Central Asian families. The following article, by Saglar Bougdaeva (“The Yelu Language of War and Peace: A Revised Oirad Translation of the Altai Runic Inscriptions”) analyses the earliest, “Runic”, evidence of written Mongolian. This investigative path is continued in the following contribution, by Erhan Aydin: “A New Reading and Interpretation of the Turkic Runic Script Text on the Wooden Rod from Khotan”. Aydin comments both on the writing contained on his key material medium, a piece of wood found in Khotan, as well as the words in early Mongolian-Turkic script that can be made out. Enkhbayar Jigmeddorj (“Textology Studies of the Mongolian Law Manuscripts on Birch Bark from the Khar Bukh Ruins”) also focuses on the intrinsic connection between the contents of the sources unearthed at the ruins of Khar Bukh, as well as on the phenomenon of preserving written data on birch bark.

In the following piece, by Christopher Atwood (“Some Place Names in the Beijing Area as Found in the *Secret History of the Mongols*”), the close connection between the Chinese language of the late imperial period is under scrutiny. Charting the meanings and pronunciations of key place names in Ming-Qing Beijing by means of the key repository of Yuan history has implications that go far beyond a simple street map. Hasanhan Taylan Erkipçak, in “Toramana and the Date of Mihirakula’s Gwalior Inscription: A New Interpretation”, deals with crucial biographical facts and historical incidents connected to Toramana, the eminent ancestral ruler of the Alkhan Huns. Ishayahu Landa, in “Famines, State, and the Stability of Mongol Eurasia: Preliminary Remarks”, explores the interplay between environmental, economic and political factors influencing the stability within the Chinggisid world across Eurasia, during the apex of Mongol power. Moving into the final years of the Qing era, Sanjaa Dulamjav “Clarifying the Tribute Paid to the Monasteries by the Disciples of Jibzundamba Khutugtu (Beginning of the Nineteenth-Twentieth Centuries)” takes this volume into modernity, by focusing on the financial transactions which supplied the Lamaist monasteries of late Qing Mongolia with vital resources. Terigele Teneg brings the article section to an end with her evaluation of the usefulness and feasibility of reintroducing traditional Mongolian writing into (Khalkh) Mongolia, to replace the Cyrillic script, which has been in use for four generations.

This volume also incorporates an obituary dedicated to the life and work of Aleksandr Vladimirovič Vovin (1961–2022), who in many ways acted as a “teacher’s teacher” to the present generation of Central Asianists. Furthermore, the Reviews section unlocks the wealth of literature on ancient Mongolian-Turkic Central Asia, for instance in a review article co-authored by Anna Turanskaya and Hartmut Walravens (“The St. Petersburg Mongolian Type Revisited”). All of the above, together with the following volume 67 of the *Central Asiatic Journal*, would have made any long-serving editor proud, and would certainly have been in the spirit of Karl Jahn.

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On the Etymology of Common Turkic *elt-* 'to carry, to bring'

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Earlier etymologies of Common Turkic *elt-*

The Common Turkic verb *elt-* ~ *elit-* ~ *elät-* ~ *älit-* ~ *älät-*, which primarily denotes 'to carry, to bring', has been attested since the oldest written documents of Turkic and is now widely represented in the modern Turkic languages including Yakut. For this very common verb, no convincing etymology has yet been proposed. All etymological suggestions are presented below in chronological order.

Ligeti (1935: 285–287) confused different verbal roots and listed CT *elt-* among numerous derivatives of CT *il-* 'to attach'. Ramstedt (1952: 197) derived CT *ilt-*, *elt-* 'bringen, führen' from CT *el* (sic) and Chuv *al* (sic) 'Hand' without further comment on its morphology. Menges (1955: 694) analysed the verb in question as **äl-(i)-t-* and derived it from *äl* (sic) 'Hand'.

Ramstedt (1957: 125) compared Tg *el-ge*¹ with Mo *el-de-* 'mit Händen bearbeiten', Tu *elt-* 'an der Hand führen' and Kor *eruda* 'leiten' and referred to an earlier work of his own for further details.² Benzing (1959: 712) was inclined to explain *leś-* as an irregular reflex of OU *ilt-* (sic) with a change of *t* > *ś*.

Räsänen (1969: 41) related Kumyk *ellen-* 'elüzetni; fortgejagt werden' [to be chased away] (Németh 1911/12: 111) to the verb in question, probably assuming that it is the passive form of its unattested base. However, Tt dial (Gaziantep, Sivas, Yozgat) *helle-* 'kuşları ürkütüp kaçırmak' [to scare away the birds] (DS 2336) shows that the Kumyk verb is unrelated to CT *elt-*.

Hamilton (1971: 103a) derived the verb from the noun *il* 'devant, avant' with the suffixes *+i-* or *+ä-* and *-(X)t-*. This cannot be accepted because the verb in question begins with /e/ whereas **il* (as in *ilgärü* and *ilki*) certainly has an onset /i/.

Sevortjan's (1974: 267–269) references to *†el-* in Xusräv u Šīrīn and *†äl-* in Altun Yaruk Sudur as the base of *elt-* are obsolete. The former is emended to *il-* 'zacześcić, uwikłać, złowić (do sieci), usidlać' [to hook, to entangle, to catch (into the net), en-

1 PTg **älgä-* 'to lead (an animal)' (EEW §3792) can be considered a loan from Mo **ilge-* < *ile-ge-* 'to send, dispatch' (Nugteren 2011: 375).

2 Ramstedt (1949: 57) traced Kor *eruda*, *elluda* 'to lead on', 'to entertain, to entice' and Kor *ellida* 'to charm' to **el-u-*, *el-gu-* and compared it with Manchu *elgi-*, *elge-* 'to lead (a horse, a caravan, etc.)', Tg *elge-* 'to lead', Ulcha *elji-ni* 'leader', Mo *elde-* 'to work with hands, to knead, to tan' and further with Turkic *el* 'hand', Chuv *-al*, *-el* 'Hand'.

trap] (Zajaczkowski 1961: 58) and the latter to *älä-* ‘to be quiet’ (Kaya 2021: 722; Wilkens 2021: 103).

Berta (1988: 118) gave some cognate forms from Middle Kipchak sources and modern Kipchak languages under Tatar *it-* ‘tragen, hinbringen’ and reconstructed **elt-* ~ **et-* for Wolga-Kipchak.

Starostin, Dybo and Mudrak (2003: 582) regarded Tu **el-t-*, **el-č-* as cognate with Tg **ilbe-* ‘to drive’ and Mo **ileye-* ‘to send’ and reconstructed **ile-* ‘to drive’ for Proto-Altaic. Robbeets (2005: 563) reproduced the same data without adding anything new. Dybo (2007: 56) reconstructed **ējl-t/č-* for Proto-Turkic but did not comment on the reconstruction or its morphology.

As illustrated above, the only etymology that is still worth discussing is the possible relationship between CT *elt-* ~ *elit-* ~ *elät-* ~ *älit-* ~ *älät-* and PT **äläg* ‘hand’ (OT *älig* ~ *elig*, Khalaj *ä-l*, Yak *älī* ~ *ilī*, Chuv *alā*) (see KhM 292). Even though PT **äläg* ‘hand’ could be derived from a hypothetical verb **äl-* ‘to hold, to grasp’, it can hardly be connected with the verb in question both from a morphological and a semantic aspect.

A new attempt at etymology

CT *elt-* ~ *elit-* ~ *elät-* ~ *älit-* ~ *älät-* must be reconstructed as **hälit-* ~ **hälät-* for the earlier stages, which, in turn, go back to Proto-Turkic **päliit-* ~ **päliät-*. The verb itself, or any derivative of it, has unfortunately not survived in Khalaj. However, the alternation of vowel onset and *y-* in Old Uyghur (*eltin-* ~ (br) *ye[ltin]-*) can be interpreted as an indication of an earlier onset **h-* (Maue 1996: XXIV, 37). This reconstruction is supported by Tt dial (Mersin) *helet-* ‘bir şeyi çok kazanmak, çok ürün almak’ [to earn a lot of something, to harvest a lot] (DS 2332), which otherwise appears in most Turkish dialects as *elet-* ‘iletmek, götürmek’ [to convey, to carry] (DS 1712). The meaning of this dialectal form from Mersin is figurative. The Turkish verb *götür-* ‘to bring, to carry’ also has a similar figurative meaning in Old Ottoman texts: ‘hasat etmek, toplamak’ [to harvest, to gather] (ÖTS 1761).

The runiform instances of the verb are spelt with both defective (implicit) and plene vowels, a circumstance that suggests the reading *elt-*.³ All Manichaean instances in *Manichaica* III, on the other hand, are spelt <’LYT->, <’L’YT-> *älit-* (UW Nb I.2: 7). Nahğ al-Farādīs, a Khwarazmian Turkic text that systematically distinguishes /e/ and /ä/, also spells this verb as *ält-* and *älät-* (Ata 1998: 119–120). DLT *elät-*, Turkmen *elt-* and Yakut *ilt-* do not exhibit vowel length. The long vowels occasionally found in Khorasan Turkic, e.g., *ērt-* ‘bringen (bordan); fortbringen’ (Tulu 1989: 283) and *ēlt-* ‘bordan = fortbringen’ (Doerfer-Hesche 1993: 586, §655) are probably secondary. Thus, the close-open /e/ is highly likely the result of the secondary raising of /ä/.

The alternation of /i/ and /ä/ in the second syllable is irregular and cannot be explained by the known sound changes in Turkic. These vowels seem to have alternated

3 Tuñuquq 18, 32, 53; Kül Tegin East 23; Bilgä Qaghan East 19; Altın Köl I (E-28) 1; Altın Köl II (E-29) 1; Irk Bitig 7, 11 (Tekin 1993: 54; Aydın 2015: 202; Şirin 2016: 505).

freely in this etymon whereas the open vowel is likely to be younger than the close one. The monosyllabic form *elt-*, on the other hand, is certainly secondary and resulted from the syncope of *elit-* or *elät-* as OU *yort-* ‘to trot, to amble’ comes from *yorīt-* (HWAU 914). The rarity of the consonant cluster /lt/ in Old Turkic (GOT 109) speaks for its secondary status. The only other word in the entire Old Turkic corpus that ends in °lt is OU *tölt* ‘cushion’. OU *tölt* is likewise syncopated from the disyllabic **tölā-t*, its base being the lambdacistic variant of *tōšā-* ‘to spread out (a mattress)’ (OTWF 425).

The oldest aorist and converb vowel of the verb attested in Manichaean texts and Irk Bitig is /i/ whereas later occurrences exhibit /ü/. This shows that the final °t- is identical to the causative suffix *-(X)t-* since the latter underwent the same change.⁴ So, we are left with the base **pāli-* ~ **pālā-*, which we can assume to have denoted something like ‘to move, to go’. Similarly, *yörügür-* ‘to carry’, which occurs in *Oyuznama*, is the causative of *yörü-* ‘to walk’ (Boeschoten 2022: 422). The Proto-Turkic base **pāli-* ~ **pālā-* was borrowed into other Altaic languages multiple times in different periods.

In the first and oldest stage, Proto-Turkic **pāli-* was borrowed through Mongolic into Proto-Tungusic as **pāli-*, from which the causative **pālbō-* ‘to lead, to bring along, to take with oneself’ was derived. The Mongolic *†peli-* has apparently not survived. However, Mo **heil-* ‘to part, to leave each other’ (Nugteren 2011: 352), which yielded, among others, SH *heyil-* ‘to leave, to depart, to go away (離)’ (Kuribayashi 2009: 192) and Written Mongol *eil-* ‘to run away, flee; to detach oneself, free oneself’ (Lessing 1995: 303), may have changed from **peli-l-* with an irregular dissimilation of the first /l/. The verbal suffix *-l-* can be identified with the iterative suffix *-(V)l-* (Kempf 2013: 103–105).⁵

- (1) PT **pāli-* (~ **pālā-*) → Mo *†peli-* (> **peli-l-* > **heil-* ‘to part’) → PTg **pāli-* (~ **pōli-*⁶?) ‘to go’ (EEW §4827) > Manchu *feliye-* ‘1. to walk, to take steps; 2. to frequent (a place); 3. to discuss marriage’ (Norman 2013: 111), Evenki хэлдэ- *helde-* ‘exat’ [to go, to ride] (Vasilevič 1958: 506), PTg **pāli-bō-* > **pālbō-* ‘to lead, to bring along, to take with oneself’ (EEW §3774) > Evenki *helbu-*, Solon *el-bū-*, Even *helbe-*, Negidal *xelbu-*, Oroch *xebbu-*, Udihe *xebu-*, Kur-Urmi *xelbu-* (SS II 363).

4 In the course of its use in Old Turkic, the causative suffix *-(X)t-* with the converb and aorist vowel /i/ changed its shape to *-(l)t-* with the converb and aorist vowel /ü/ (OTWF 799).

5 In contrast to the etymology presented here, Kempf (2013: 104) traced SH *heyil-* back to **hegi-* and tentatively related it to Written Mongol *ege-* ‘to return, to go back; to fall back, retreat; to die’. This suggestion is inaccurate since Proto-Mongolic **/g/* (< Pre-Proto-Mongolic **/k/*) as found in Written Mongol *ege-* and Khalkha *egex* does not give /y/ in front of /i/.

6 PTg **pōli-* ‘to go’ > Jurchen *fuli-*, Solon *ul-*, Even *höl-*, Negidal *xul-*, Oroch *xuli-*, Ulcha *pulikte-*, Orok *puli-*, Nanai *pulsi-*, Kur-Urmi *xuli-* (SS 363–364; Doerfer 1978: 90, §71). It is unclear whether **pōli-* is an early variant of **pāli-* or a separate root. Doerfer (1978: 90, §71) included Manchu *feliye-* to this cognate set. Although Doerfer (EEW §4827) took **pāli-* into consideration, he favoured the reconstruction of **pōli-*.

In the second stage, PT **pāli-* yielded **heli-* ~ **helä-* in both Common Turkic and Bulgar Turkic. The latter form entered Mongolic as **ile-* ‘to go’, from which **ilee-* and **ile-ge-* ‘to send, to dispatch’ were derived. Mo. **ile-* ‘to go’ is retained in SH as *ile-* ‘gehen, hingehen, weggehen (去)’ [to go, to go away] (Haenisch 1939: 81). The substitution of Turkic /e/ by Mongolic /i/ is paralleled by Mo **ire-* ‘to come’ (Nugteren 2011: 376), which was borrowed from Tu *ēr-* ‘to reach, to arrive’ (Khalaj *īr-*) (ED 194; WCh 137–138). Because Pre-Proto-Mongolic **p-* had not yet changed to Proto-Mongolic **h-* at that time, CT **h-* was substituted by the vocalic onset in Mongolic. This dates the borrowing to a period between the 5th and 12th centuries. I have previously provided a list of Turkic loanwords in Mongolic that have vocalic onsets even though their donor forms exhibit *h-* (Ünal 2022: 54).

(2) CT/BT **heli-* ~ **helä-* → Mo **ile-* ‘to go’ (Nugteren 2011: 375) > Mo **ilee-* ‘to send, dispatch’ (Nugteren 2011: 375); cf. MA *hile-* [hilē-] ‘to send’ (Poppe 1938: 185; Saitō 2008: 314).

In the third stage, CT **heli-* ~ **helä-* has yielded numerous derivations, but the base itself has not been retained. All attested derivations are listed below.

(3.1) CT **heli-t-* ~ **helä-t-* > CT *elt-* ~ *elit-* ~ *elät-* ~ *älit-* ~ *älät-* (OU *älit-*, DLT *elät-*, Tkm *elt-*, Yak *ilt-*) ‘to carry, to bring, to carry away’ (ED 132; Sevortjan 1974: 267–269; UW Nb I.2: 7–13; Boeschoten 2022: 54), Tt dial (Mersin) *helet-* ‘bir şeyi çok kazanmak, çok ürün almak’ [to earn a lot of something, harvest a lot] (DS 2332) → Mo **elte-*⁷ > *elde-* ‘to drive, chase, pursue’ (Lessing 1995: 307).

(3.2) CT **heli-t-in-* > OU *eltin-* ~ (br) *ye[ltin]-* ‘to carry with one, to acquire, to get etc.’ (Maue 1996: 37; UW Nb I.2: 13–15).

(3.3) CT **heli-t-iş-* > OT *eltiś-* ‘to get along’ (Zieme 2016).⁸

(3.4) CT **heli-gür-* > OU *elgür-* ‘mit Akk. (Leben, Körper [?]): bewahren, aufbewahren // (hayat, beden [?]) korumak, muhafaza etmek (in ShōAgon 196:2 Übers[etzung] von chin. *cun* 存 ‘bewahren, aufbewahren’)’ (UW Nb I.2: 7)⁹ > OU (syr) *älgürçi* ‘Bewahrer, Aufseher (?) // bekçi, gözcü, koruyucu (?)’ (UW Nb II.2: 179).

The semantic change from CT **heli-gür-* ‘to let sth walk’ to OU *elgür-* ‘to maintain’ is paralleled by the Chagatay verb *yür[i]t-* ‘sürdürmek, devam ettirmek, yürütmek’ [to maintain, to continue, to carry out] (Üşenmez 2019: 754), which is the causative of *yür-i-* ‘to go, walk, to march’. The syncopation of the final vowel of the verbal base is also observed in the formation of *ärgür-* ‘to melt (tr.)’, which is derived from *ärü-* ‘to melt (intr.)’ (OTWF 748–749).

7 The final vowel of **elte-* is anaptyctic because the Mongolic language does not allow consonant clusters such as /lt/ at the coda position.

8 Uçar (2022: 406) analysed *eltiś-* as *el+e-t-iş-* (= *el+ä-t-iş-*) and regarded its base as a cognate to Mo *el* ‘accord, harmony, peace; union; ally’.

9 It is worth noting that the verbs *eltin-* and *elgür-* co-occur in a sentence in ShōAgon 196:2: *tärs öz eltinmāk üzä isig özin elgürmäsär* ‘If one cannot preserve his life because he maintains his life in the wrong way’.

(3.5) CT **heli-nti* ‘(a woman) who wanders around’, hence ‘prostitute’ > Khalaj *h’ēlinti* ‘Schlampe’ [with secondary vowel length] (WCh 131), *h’ēlinti-t’ēlinti* ‘unordentliche Frau, Schlampe’ (WCh 131).

The formative *-(X)ndI* ~ *-(X)ntI* occasionally forms pejorative nouns for human beings; cf. Ott *uyundu* ~ *uyuntu* ‘1. kendi başına hareket edemeyip başkasının reyine uyan; 2. tufeyli, asalak’ [1. unable to act on his/her own and following someone else’s opinion; 2. parasitic] (TS 4044–4045), which is derived from Ott *uy-* < CT *ud-* ‘to follow’. The semantic change in Khalaj is not surprising. Similarly, Tt *sürtük* ‘Herumtreiberin’ [drifter, prowler] and *yolcu* ‘Reisende, Weggefährtin’ [traveller, companion] (Laut 2005: 110) figuratively denote ‘prostitute’.

(3.6) CT **heli-gin*¹⁰ > **helkin* ‘someone who goes (away)’ > *elkin* ~ *yelkin* > Xemčik-Čirgākī (E-41) <ɫ²g²n²> (*e*)*lg(i)n* or (*ä*)*lg(i)n*¹¹ ‘traveller’ (?) (Kormuşin 2008: 56), DLT <’ALKIN> *älkin* ~ <’ILKIN> *elkin* ~ <YALKIN>, <YALKIN> *yälkin*¹² ‘traveller (musafir)’ (Dankoff–Kelly 1982–1985/III: 222), IM *älkin* (Ar *al-ğā’ib*)¹³ ‘göz önünde hazır bulunmayan’ [not present] (Battal 1934: 29), ‘yitik; yok olan’ [lost; vanished] (Karagözlü 2018: 280), KI *älkin* ‘garip, kimsesiz’ [poor, lonely] (Caferoğlu 1931: 10), IH *älgin* (read *älkin* ?) ‘yabancı (fakir)’ [stranger (poor)] (Izbudak 1936: 18), Ott *älgin* (read *älkin* ?) ‘garip, âciz, miskin, sefil’ [strange, helpless, sluggish, miserable] (TS 1431), Ott (42b/15) *älkin* ‘passenger, traveller’ (Akkuş 1995: 308, 540¹⁴), Tt dial (Isparta) *elkin* ‘arsız, yaramaz, şımarık’ [cheeky, naughty, spoiled] (DS 1719), Tkm *elkin* ‘ayrıbaşgalıkda yaşamak, eke, özbaşdak, ayrı’ [living apart, separate, independent] (Xamzaev 1962: 807).

Note that Old Turkic *barkin* ‘a determined traveller’ (ED 360; OTWF 329), derived from *bar-* ‘to go’, comes very close to the morphology and semantics of *elkin* ~ *yelkin*.

10 *-gXn* denotes the agent of intransitive verbs, and all nouns formed with *-gXn* are disyllabic (OTWF 327).

11 The expected form would be (*E*)*lk(i)n* with /k/. However, this particular inscription exhibits irregularities in the spelling of /k/: *gaşga* (CT *kaşga* ‘with a white blaze on the forehead’), *gämčig* (CT *kämčik* ‘the Khemchik’).

12 Clauson (ED 928) derived this word from *yäl-* ‘to trot’. However, CT *yäl-* does not lose its onset consonant in Oghuz: Ott *yel-* (= *yäl-*) ~ *yil-* (= *yel-*) ‘1. Koşmak, şıtap etmek, acele yürümek, esmek; 2. (Hayvan) tırıs gitmek, eşkin yürümek, hızlıca yürümek’ [1. to run, to walk in a hurry, blow; 2. (animal) to trot, walk briskly] (TS 4505–4511), Tt dial *yel-* ~ *yil-* ‘1. Bir işin, bir şeyin, birinin peşinde koşmak, koşturmak; 2. Çabuk yürümek; 3. Amaçsız gezip dolaşmak’ [1. to run after a job, something or someone; 2. to walk quickly; 3. to wander aimlessly] (DS 4238). Tietze (2016–2020: 585) thought that Clauson’s etymology required further explanation for the presumed semantic change.

13 ‘Absent, not present, not there; hidden, concealed, unseen, invisible; third person (*gram.*)’ (Wehr 1976: 689).

14 The editor of the text interpreted the word as ‘garip, miskin; misafir’, which is apparently copied from other sources. The passage reads: [...] *älkinlärä ya’ni müsäfirälärä* [...] ‘to the *elkins*, that is, to the passengers’. This fixes the meaning.

(3.7) BT **helä-lč-* ‘to go together’, hence ‘to escort, to accompany’¹⁵ > **iläč-* > Chuv *leš-* ‘(el)vinni; elkisérni | wegführen, fortbringen; begleiten’ [to carry away, take away, to accompany] (Paasonen 1974: 82), Chuv *leš-* ‘otnesti, otvezti; vozvrašat’, prinosit’; peredvigat’, perenosit’, podnosit’ [to carry, take away; to return, bring; to move, to carry], *yeš-* ‘otnosit’, snosit’, privodit’, svozit’, otvezti’ [to carry, to bring, to take away] (Ašmarin ²1994–2000: 4/288, 8/81).

Conclusion

There are not many proposed etymologies for the Common Turkic verb *elt-* ~ *elit-* ~ *elät-* ~ *älit-* ~ *älät-* ‘to carry, to bring’. It has occasionally been linked to the Turkic noun for ‘hand’. This proposal is semantically and, more importantly, morphologically not convincing. In the present study, *elt-* ~ *elit-* ~ *elät-* ~ *älit-* ~ *älät-* are identified as the causative forms of the base **häli-* ~ **hälä-* and are ultimately traced back to the Proto-Turkic form **päli-* ~ **pälä-* ‘to go’. Mongolic **heil-* (< **peli-l-*) ‘to go away’ and Proto-Tungusic **päli-* ‘to go’ as well as Common Mongolic **ile-* ‘to go’ are loanwords from the latter. In summary, the Proto-Turkic verb **päli-* ~ **pälä-* ‘to go’ is of indigenous origin and entered other “Altaic” languages more than once in different forms at different times.

Abbreviations

Ar	Arabic
br	Brāhmī script
BT	Bulgar Turkic
Chuv	Chuvash
CT	Common Turkic
DLT	Dīwān Luyāt at-Turk
IH	El-Idrāk Haşiyesi [Margin Grammar]
IM	Ibn al-Muhannā
KI	Kitāb al-idrāk li-lisān al-atrāk
Kor	Korean
MA	Muqaddimat al-Adab
Mo	Mongolic
OT	Old Turkic
Ott	Ottoman Turkish
OU	Old Uyghur
PT	Proto-Turkic
PTg	Proto-Tungusic
SH	The Secret History of the Mongols (Mongqolun Niuča Tobča’an)
syr	Syrian script
Tg	Tungusic

15 Räsänen (1969: 41a) reconstructed **iläč-* as the source of Chuv *leš-*; cf. also Grønbech (1902: 89).

Tkm	Turkmen
Tt dial	Turkish dialectal
Tu	Turkic
Yak	Yakut

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